

Chapter 03 Homework — Rings

Mikey Ferguson

September 2, 2026

Problem 03.1. Suppose that S is a set and R is a ring. Let R^S denote the set of all mappings from S to R . Show that R^S is a ring, under the operations defined by

$$(f + g)(s) = f(s) + g(s), \quad (fg)(s) = f(s)g(s).$$

Show that if S has more than one element then there exist non-zero elements f and g in R^S for which $fg = 0$.

Solution. Write $f_1, f_0 \in R^S$ for the functions

$$f_1(s) = 1_R, \quad f_0(s) = 0_R,$$

and clearly, by the specified function properties, we have all ring properties.

Prove $(f + g)h = fh + gh$. Let $s \in S$. Show $((f + g)h)(s) = (fh)(s) + (gh)(s)$:

$$((f + g)h)(s) = (f(s) + g(s))h(s) = f(s)h(s) + g(s)h(s) = (fh)(s) + (gh)(s).$$

If $|S| > 1$, there exist $s_1, s_2 \in S$ where $s_1 \neq s_2$. Let

$$f(s) = \begin{cases} 1_R & s = s_1 \\ 0_R & \text{else} \end{cases} \quad g(s) = \begin{cases} 1_R & s = s_2 \\ 0_R & \text{else} \end{cases}$$

Then $f(s)g(s) = 0$, so they are zero divisors.

Problem 03.2. Suppose that R is an integral domain, with field of fractions F . Show that the field of fractions of $R[x_1, \dots, x_n]$ can be identified naturally with $F(x_1, \dots, x_n)$.

Problem 03.3. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.8. Suppose that K is a field. If $f = a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_nx^n \in K[x]$ and $k \in K$, let $(\Phi(f))(k) = a_0 + a_1k + \dots + a_nk^n$. Show that Φ is a ring homomorphism from $K[x]$ to K^K . Show that if K is finite then Φ is an epimorphism, but not a monomorphism. What happens if K is infinite?

Solution. Let $f = \sum_i a_i x^i$ and $g = \sum_i b_i x^i$ in $K[x]$.

Additive half. Let $k \in K$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} (\Phi(f + g))(k) &= \left(\Phi\left(\sum_i (a_i + b_i)x^i\right) \right)(k) = \sum_i (a_i + b_i)k^i = \sum_i a_i k^i + \sum_i b_i k^i \\ &= \left(\Phi\left(\sum_i a_i x^i\right) \right)(k) + \left(\Phi\left(\sum_i b_i x^i\right) \right)(k) = (\Phi(f))(k) + (\Phi(g))(k). \end{aligned}$$

As $k \in K$ was arbitrary, $\Phi(f + g) = \Phi(f) + \Phi(g)$ in K^K .

Multiplicative half. Let $k \in K$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} (\Phi(fg))(k) &= \left(\Phi \left(\sum_m \left(\sum_{i+j=m} a_i b_j \right) x^m \right) \right)(k) = \sum_m \left(\sum_{i+j=m} a_i b_j \right) k^m \\ &= \left(\sum_i a_i k^i \right) \left(\sum_j b_j k^j \right) = \left(\Phi \left(\sum_i a_i x^i \right) \right)(k) \cdot \left(\Phi \left(\sum_j b_j x^j \right) \right)(k) = (\Phi(f))(k) (\Phi(g))(k). \end{aligned}$$

Φ is not a monomorphism. Take $K = \mathbb{F}_2$, $f = x^2 + x$ and $g = 0$. Then $f \neq g$ in $\mathbb{F}_2[x]$, but

$$(\Phi(f))(0) = 0 = (\Phi(g))(0), \quad (\Phi(f))(1) = 1 + 1 = 0 = (\Phi(g))(1),$$

so $\Phi(f) = \Phi(g)$ in $\mathbb{F}_2^{\mathbb{F}_2}$ and $\ker \Phi \neq \{0\}$.

Problem 03.10. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.11. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.12. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.14. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.15. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.17. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.25. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*

Problem 03.26. *[TODO: statement not yet transcribed]*